

Developer & Client Management Questions

1. Requirements & Client Communication

- Understanding ambiguous client requests:
"The client asked for a 'modern dashboard with analytics,' but they didn't specify which metrics actually matter to them. What should I do here?"
- Handling client pushback / scope creep during calls:
"During our updates call, the client casually mentioned adding a multi-role login (Admin, Editor, Viewer), but our initial agreement was just single-admin access. How do I politely tell them that this will add extra time/cost without sounding rude?"
- Translating non-technical client words:
"The client keeps saying the site feels 'slow and non-responsive,' but the load time is fine. Do you think they mean layout responsiveness/mobile UI, or UI animation lag? How should I clarify this with them?"

2. Project Scope & Scope Creep Prevention

- Drafting boundaries in the contract/SOW:
"I'm writing down the project scope for this e-commerce site. How specific should I be about revisions? Should I explicitly state 'Maximum 2 rounds of UI revisions,' and what happens if they ask for a 3rd round?"
- Handling unexpected technical blockers in scope:
"I realized mid-way that the third-party API the client wants to use requires a paid enterprise tier that they haven't bought yet. How do I explain this blocker to them and adjust the roadmap?"
- Managing timelines and deadlines:
"The client took 5 days to respond with the API keys, and now the delivery deadline is in 2 days. How do I request a timeline extension professionally?"

3. Design, Architecture & Roadmaps

- Translating Figma to Code:
"The client provided a Figma file, but the mobile designs are missing for half the pages. Should I pause work and ask them for mobile mockups, or make sensible layout assumptions myself?"
- Understanding Legacy/Client Systems:
"Can you explain the architecture of the previous tool that the client shared with us? How do all the components and services fit together?"
- Choosing the right tech stack for the project:
"The project requires real-time notifications. I don't have much idea on this, can you help me on how to work on a notification system?"

- Database schema & planning:
"I'm designing the schema for a subscription platform. Should I handle user roles and permissions directly in the main users table using ENUMs, or should I create a separate roles and permissions relational table from day one?"
- Project Roadmap & Milestones:
"We have 4 weeks to complete this MVP. How should I break down the deliverables into weekly milestones so the client can review functional progress without waiting until the last week?"

4. Development, Debugging & Code Architecture

- Handling Authentication & Edge Cases:
"I implemented JWT authentication, but I'm confused about token refresh logic. Should I store access tokens in localStorage or httpOnly cookies for a freelance client project?"
- Handling Third-Party Integrations:
"I'm integrating Stripe webhooks for payment verification, but in local development, the webhook events aren't reaching my localhost server. What tool or proxy setup should I use to debug this?"
- Performance & Optimization:
"The image gallery component is re-rendering every time the user types in the search bar and slowing down the UI. Could you help me spot if it's a state management issue or missing memoization?"

5. Deployment, Environment Setup & Handoff

- Managing Credentials & Environment Variables:
"The client gave me their production database URL and credentials directly over WhatsApp. Where should I store these safely, and how do I manage separate .env files for staging and production?"
- Managing Environment Variables:
"How do I set up and use .env files in our project, and why shouldn't we commit secrets directly into the repository?"
- Deployment Setup:
"Should I deploy the frontend on Vercel/Netlify and the backend on Render/AWS, or keep everything under one provider? What's the easiest setup for the client to manage after I hand it over?"
- Domain & DNS Configuration:
"The client owns a domain on GoDaddy, but our app is hosted on Vercel. How do I safely ask for DNS access or guide them through adding the CNAME and A records without breaking their existing business email setup?"
- Final Handoff & Maintenance:
"The project is complete and ready to deploy. What documentation should I provide them

(e.g., README, API docs, environment setup guide) so they don't have to reach out for every tiny configuration change?"

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6. Git & Version Control Best Practices

- Creating Pull Requests:
"Can you walk me through how to properly raise a Pull Request (PR) in Git from start to finish?"
- Branching Strategy:
"Why should we create separate branches for separate features instead of pushing directly to a single branch?"

7. Database Performance & Troubleshooting

- Fixing Slow Frontend–Database Connections:
"Our frontend is experiencing high latency when fetching data from the database. Since the DB stores data in a complex/nested structure, how can we identify the bottleneck and fix this performance issue?"

8. Database Schema Design & Optimization

- Schema Refactoring & Data Modeling:
"How should we design or optimize this nested database schema? Which fields/structures should we keep, which should we strip out or flatten, and what best practices should we follow?"

9. Web Hosting & Domain Configuration

- Connecting a Website to a Custom Domain:
"I've built and hosted a website, but neither I nor the client knows how domain DNS settings work. Can you explain step-by-step how to link our website to a custom domain name?"